

Senators concerns surveilla

era

This website uses cookies and other tracking technologies to enhance user experience, to display personalized advertisements and to analyze performance and traffic on our website. We also share information about your use of our site with our social media, advertising and analytics partners. You can exercise your rights to opt-out of sale of processing personal data for targeted advertising by clicking the "Customize" link. For more details see our [Privacy Policy](#)

Customize

Reject All

Accept All



By Ariana Figueroa

Published: Sep. 27, 2026 at 7:56 PM UTC | Updated: 19 hours ago



WASHINGTON (Iowa Capital Dispatch) - A vast and growing network of artificial intelligence-driven Flock cameras could violate constitutional privacy rights, U.S. senators on a Judiciary Committee subcommittee said during a Wednesday hearing.

GOP Sen. Josh Hawley of Missouri, the chair of the Crime and Counterterrorism Subcommittee, said the point of the hearing was to find out “what is going on with the expanding surveillance network that appears to be going coast to coast in this country.”

Hawley said he invited Sen. Cory Gardner of Colorado to the hearing.

Senators heard from Flock camera

captured a photo of

This website uses cookies and other tracking technologies to enhance user experience, to display personalized advertisements and to analyze performance and traffic on our website. We also share information about your use of our site with our social media, advertising and analytics partners. You can exercise your rights to opt-out of sale of processing personal data for targeted advertising by clicking the "Customize" link. For more details see our [Privacy Policy](#)

They speculated the information gathered by the device / because the law enforcement agencies movements without a warrant.

“If you haven’t heard

“I’m sure we’re all in the database.”

Hawley said.

Flock did not respond to States Newsroom’s request for comment.

What is Flock?

Flock cameras track and record every motor vehicle that comes into view, including its license plate number, make, model, bumper stickers and color. They can also capture images of people.

The information is then uploaded to a database that any law enforcement agency that contracts with the company can access without a warrant.

There are more than 120,000 Flock cameras installed across the country from highways to outside grocery stores, [according to the American Civil Liberties Union](#). The only U.S. state that does not have a Flock camera is Hawaii.

Media outlets such as The Washington Post have documented abuses of the service, including law enforcement officers using the devices [to stalk ex-girlfriends](#).

U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement [has also tapped into Flock](#) data through local law enforcement officials to read license plates for immigration-related searches, even though [Flock](#)

denies having a contract with ICE.



The backlash to the
vandalization of Flock

reporting

RELATED

Whiteside Co

suse

TV6 Investig

month

Whiteside Co

misuse

This website uses cookies and other tracking technologies to enhance user experience, to display personalized advertisements and to analyze performance and traffic on our website. We also share information about your use of our site with our social media, advertising and analytics partners. You can exercise your rights to opt-out of sale of processing personal data for targeted advertising by clicking the "Customize" link. For more details see our [Privacy Policy](#)

Sterling Police end Flock camera contract citing privacy, public trust concerns

Mayor: Public outcry played a large role in the decision to shut down Flock in Moline

'The potential is there to be able to find people quickly.': QC Missing Persons Network weighs in on flock camera pause

Galva Police to discontinue Flock camera program

Vandals are destroying Flock cameras across Quad-Cities

Arizona sheriff brushed off, he says

One of the witnesses at Wednesday's hearing, Ross Teeple, the sheriff of Pinal County, Arizona, said he ultimately decided to end a contract with Flock because he had raised privacy concerns the company did not adequately address.

Some of his constituents said they were worried that people could be identified in images taken by Flock cameras. He said when he asked the company about how people could be clearly seen in the images, he felt the company brushed aside his concerns and told him the image resolution was not good enough to recognize a person.

“I’m looking at camera pictures where I could recognize the person on the camera, but that was their claim ..., and there was just too much disinformation from them and dishonesty,” he said. “I was trying to get answers from them, and they would not give me answers... and there were too many concerns. So we just decided not to continue our contract.”

False accusation

Hawley said his mother was innocent until proven guilty.

He pointed to one of the cameras involved in a car accident recognition camera.

The car involved in the crash was black, while the car in the crash was maroon, as described by a witness.

Law enforcement still arrested her at her home.

This website uses cookies and other tracking technologies to enhance user experience, to display personalized advertisements and to analyze performance and traffic on our website. We also share information about your use of our site with our social media, advertising and analytics partners. You can exercise your rights to opt-out of sale of processing personal data for targeted advertising by clicking the "Customize" link. For more details see our [Privacy Policy](#)

right to be treated

accused of being
license plate

as Isaacs'. But

She spent three days in solitary confinement and then moved to another maximum-security unit for 10 days before she was released and state prosecutors dropped charges, she told the panel.

“In my case, a Flock camera captured my vehicle a few miles from the scene of a terrible crash,” she said. “That piece of information became part of an investigation that ultimately led to my arrest on three counts of vehicular homicide and 13 days in jail for a crash I had nothing to do with.”

Hawley said what he finds “so troubling” is that many drivers or people walking by are being surveilled and they’ve done nothing wrong.

“It sounds as if, based on the reports we’ve heard, it’s treating every citizen in America, I mean, by now, surely almost all of us have been scanned and logged as if we are criminals, yet without any due process, without any reasonable suspicion, without any articulable suspicion whatsoever,” he said. “This just seems very, very strange, to put it mildly, and something I think this committee really needs to hear about.”



Abortion track

New Jersey Democr
in states with strict

ACLU's Chad Marlow
for those services.

Hawley agreed with
certain people, such

"When you have thi
absolutely incredibl

This website uses cookies and other tracking technologies to enhance user experience, to display personalized advertisements and to analyze performance and traffic on our website. We also share information about your use of our site with our social media, advertising and analytics partners. You can exercise your rights to opt-out of sale of processing personal data for targeted advertising by clicking the "Customize" link. For more details see our [Privacy Policy](#)

l to track women

people searching

a database of

g to be

Marlow said the scenarios that Booker and Hawley cited are closer than they think.

"If you build it, they will come," he said. "I so much appreciate that you're bringing (up) abortion care seekers and gun owners because they are part of the same community when it comes to the threat of mass surveillance. This is something we need to be worried about because when you create the temptation, when you create the option for population control, at some point someone's going to use it."

Copyright 2026 KWQC. All rights reserved.

MDs Say Mental Decline Begins When Seniors Can't Pronounce These 3 Phrases. Can You?

APP | Sponsored

[Learn More](#)

Here Are 28+ of The Coolest Gifts for Fall 2026

Cool Gifts for 2026 | Sponsored

[Shop Now](#)

New SUVs With Tiny Price Tags (Take A Look)

Timeshare Res

SilverPenny | Sponsored

Men Over 40 Are D

Most Men with E.D. D

Directmeds | Sponsored

Arizona: Worst ZII

Check rates now—ma

OTTO Insurance | Sponsored

This website uses cookies and other tracking technologies to enhance user experience, to display personalized advertisements and to analyze performance and traffic on our website. We also share information about your use of our site with our social media, advertising and analytics partners. You can exercise your rights to opt-out of sale of processing personal data for targeted advertising by clicking the "Customize" link. For more details see our [Privacy Policy](#)

the List?

Learn more

Learn More

Click Here

9 Out Of 10 Sharp Seniors Avoid These 3 Morning Mistakes (See The List)

The Vitality Heritage Journal | Sponsored

ADVERTISEMENT

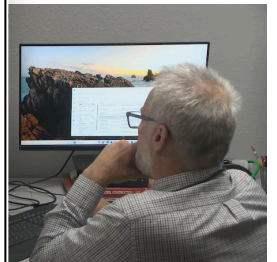
Most Read

▶ 17-year-old found dead in Waterloo; gunfire reported in area



▶ Cedar Rapids

This website uses cookies and other tracking technologies to enhance user experience, to display personalized advertisements and to analyze performance and traffic on our website. We also share information about your use of our site with our social media, advertising and analytics partners. You can exercise your rights to opt-out of sale of processing personal data for targeted advertising by clicking the "Customize" link. For more details see our [Privacy Policy](#)



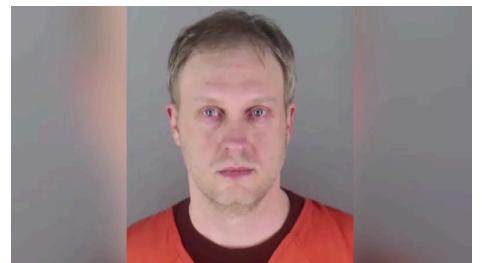
▶ Undefeated Hawks ahead of Ohio State



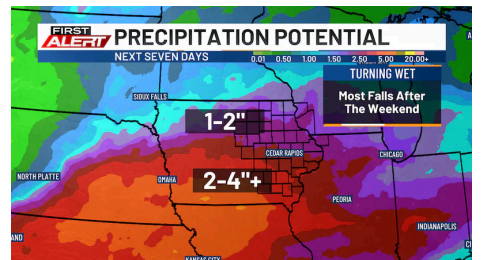
▶ Cedar Rapids firefighters respond to fire at Cypress Lofts



▶ Ex-state senator sentenced in child trafficking case



Showers again today, but a day of dry weather ahead



Dowling Catholic Freshman Football Coach recovering after cardiac emergency on bus



▶ Police investigate neighborhood

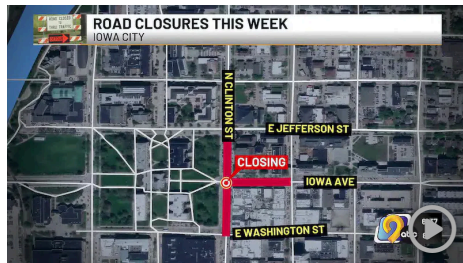
This website uses cookies and other tracking technologies to enhance user experience, to display personalized advertisements and to analyze performance and traffic on our website. We also share information about your use of our site with our social media, advertising and analytics partners. You can exercise your rights to opt-out of sale of processing personal data for targeted advertising by clicking the "Customize" link. For more details see our [Privacy Policy](#)



Latest News



Indianola



Iowa City closing some streets this week for downtown events

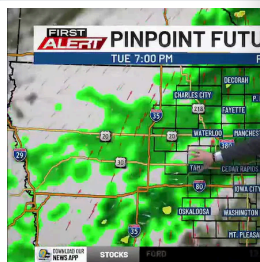


▶ Largest steel plant in US coming to Iowa, White House officials share



▶ Iowa City announces street closures this week

TOP STORIES



This website uses cookies and other tracking technologies to enhance user experience, to display personalized advertisements and to analyze performance and traffic on our website. We also share information about your use of our site with our social media, advertising and analytics partners. You can exercise your rights to opt-out of sale of processing personal data for targeted advertising by clicking the "Customize" link. For more details see our [Privacy Policy](#)

September 28th



Indianola



Iowa City chef loses home in fire, leans on faith, family, and community

News

First Alert
Weather

KCRG
501 2nd Ave SE
Cedar Rapids, IA 52401

Sports

Contact Us

YouNe

KCRG

Show

Athlete

Week

TV Lis

This website uses cookies and other tracking technologies to enhance user experience, to display personalized advertisements and to analyze performance and traffic on our website. We also share information about your use of our site with our social media, advertising and analytics partners. You can exercise your rights to opt-out of sale of processing personal data for targeted advertising by clicking the "Customize" link. For more details see our [Privacy Policy](#)

Public Inspe

399-5999

Closed Captioni

EO Statement

Advertising

Digital Marketing

Boxing

Customize

[Click here to learn more about our approach to artificial intelligence.](#)

A Gray Local Media Station © 2002-2026